

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

+91-9440493097 | pavan.nayakanti@hotmail.com | linkedin.com/in/pavan-nayakanti | github.com/pavannayakanti |
Hyderabad, India

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director-level platform and DevOps engineering leader with 20+ years delivering cloud-native infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, and GitOps-driven deployment workflows for financial services firms - including Charles Schwab, ADP, BMO, and RBC. Deep expertise in Azure/AKS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, multi-environment release governance, and DevSecOps (SAST/DAST/IAST across 250+ production applications). Proven track record building high-performing platform engineering teams from the ground up (18-member Charles Schwab team; 35-member ADP SRE org), establishing SLI/SLO frameworks, driving MTTR reduction of 40%+, and governing regulated CI/CD estates at scale. Experienced in GCC delivery models, cross-geography team leadership, and presenting platform strategy to senior business stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AKS / Kubernetes Platform Engineering

GitOps & Multi-Environment Deployments (Helm, ArgoCD)

CI/CD - Azure DevOps & GitHub Actions

Terraform IaC & Infrastructure Automation

DevSecOps & Security Scanning (SAST/DAST/IAST)

Observability - Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager

SLI/SLO, Error Budgets & Incident Management

Financial Services & Regulated Environments

WORK EXPERIENCE

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 - Present

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

- Platform engineering team built from zero:** Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up - establishing AKS cluster governance, Helm chart standards, multi-environment deployment workflows (dev/staging/production), release gates, and SLO-driven reliability reviews across the Schwab-TD Ameritrade merger integration programme.
- Kubernetes & AKS operations:** Managed multi-cluster AKS estates across banking clients - configuring RBAC, namespace isolation, resource policies, network policies, pod security, and container image lifecycle including build pipelines, image registries, and security scanning integration.
- CI/CD & GitOps pipeline design:** Designed and delivered Helm-driven multi-environment deployment pipelines (dev/staging/prod) using Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions - enforcing environment-specific configurations, deployment repeatability, traceability, and rollback capabilities across containerized application workloads.
- IaC at scale:** Authored and maintained Terraform modules for provisioning Azure infrastructure (AKS, networking, Key Vault, storage, databases) - governing IaC standards and enforcing compliance guardrails across three major banking clients.
- SLI/SLO framework & MTTR -40%+:** Defined and governed SLIs, SLOs, and error budgets across ADP and Schwab platforms; deployed AIOps-driven automated remediation via Ansible + Dynatrace; instituted blameless postmortem culture and RCA standardisation across a 35-member SRE team.
- Managed on-call rotations, escalation frameworks, and incident severity models - governing Sev-1/Sev-2 response, RCA documentation, and remediation planning across multi-client environments.
- Governed MSP and vendor delivery quality through operational scorecards, SLA tracking, and structured escalation/remediation frameworks across banking clients.
- Led GCP landing zone preparation and workload migration POCs for Charles Schwab; executed cross-platform artifact deployment alignment across TD Ameritrade and Charles Schwab as part of the merger integration programme.

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist | Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

- **DevSecOps from zero - 250+ applications:** Enabled SAST, DAST, and IAST scanning as core security objectives across RBC Insurance - integrating SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, Jenkins, and GitHub into CI/CD pipelines to enforce shift-left security, image vulnerability scanning, and dependency management across 250+ applications.
- **Release governance at scale:** Governed enterprise-wide change management across 250+ applications and 60+ teams - standardising deployment workflows, enforcing SOX/GDPR compliance, maintaining <5% change failure rate, and ensuring audit-ready change transparency.
- Embedded DORA framework - Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, MTTR - as primary engineering health metrics across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance; drove measurable improvement in delivery performance.
- Implemented Splunk-based log aggregation and alerting pipelines integrated with CI/CD - enabling proactive detection and rapid response to production incidents across regulated application estates.
- Reduced application onboarding time from **5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction)** via the Robo Deployment Framework - demonstrating the automation-first approach required to scale developer platform operations.
- Managed secrets securely using Azure Key Vault integrated with Kubernetes workloads - enforcing least-privilege access and secrets rotation across CI/CD pipelines.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018

Automation Architect | Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated infrastructure using **Kubernetes and Helm** - enabling zero-downtime rollouts and autoscaling across capital markets platforms.
- Pioneered Cognitive Process Automation (CPA/IPA) - automating 80+ applications and 250+ components across heterogeneous stacks; standardised Python automation frameworks for regulated delivery.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

Sr. SDET - Production Engineering | India (US, EMEA, APAC)

- Owned complete production operations and quality engineering for Sales & Marketing platforms serving Microsoft subsidiaries globally - accountable for CI/CD pipeline reliability, incident response, infrastructure administration, and **99.99% uptime over 7 years**.
- Built QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD; supported 200% user growth with no degradation in release quality or platform reliability.

TechMahindra

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017

Technology Manager | Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

- Architected and delivered zero-downtime application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation - full execution and cutover across all production workloads with no service disruption.
- Led cross-functional global engineering teams across large-scale enterprise delivery programmes in regulated environments.

KEY PROJECTS

Charles Schwab - Platform Engineering Team & AKS Estate GCC Bootstrap / Developer Platform

Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero during the TD Ameritrade merger integration - establishing AKS cluster governance, Helm chart standards, multi-environment CI/CD workflows (dev/staging/prod), RBAC and network policy frameworks, release gates, and SLO-driven reliability reviews. Executed cross-platform artifact deployment alignment across TD Ameritrade and Schwab environments. Led GCP landing zone POCs evaluating cloud-native deployments. Improved release reliability to 99.9%.

AKS · Kubernetes · Helm · Azure DevOps · GitHub Actions · Terraform · Prometheus · Grafana · GCP

RBC DevSecOps - CI/CD Governance & Security at Scale DevSecOps / Regulated CI/CD

Built DevSecOps practice from zero at RBC Insurance - SAST/DAST/IAST scanning (SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory) across 250+ applications, SOX/GDPR-compliant release governance across 60+ teams, Azure Key Vault secrets management integrated with Kubernetes, and Splunk-based observability pipelines. Established DORA metrics across Wealth Management and Insurance divisions. Change failure rate held below 5%. Onboarding reduced 98% via the Robo Deployment Framework.

Azure DevOps · Jenkins · GitHub · SonarQube · JFrog Artifactory · Splunk · Azure Key Vault · Python · Ansible

ADP SRE - Observability, Incident Management & MTTR Reduction SRE at Scale

Scaled ADP's SRE organisation from 4 to 35 engineers. Deployed full-stack observability using Prometheus, Grafana, and Dynatrace with AIOps-driven automated remediation via Ansible. Defined SLIs, SLOs, and error budgets from scratch; instituted blameless postmortem culture and RCA standardisation. MTTR reduced by 40%+; zero repeat Sev-1 incidents in 18 months. Implemented Chaos Engineering (Keptn) for proactive fault identification.

Prometheus · Grafana · Dynatrace · Alertmanager · Ansible · Splunk · ServiceNow · ITIL · Keptn

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence - Woolf University	2024
General Management Program (GMP) - ISB Hyderabad	2022
M.Sc in Computer Science - Osmania University	2002

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)	Microsoft	2026
Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)	CNCF	2025
ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations	AXELOS	
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C01)	Amazon Web Services	2026
Google Cloud Certified - Professional Cloud Architect (PCA)	Google	2026
Certified SRE (iSRE)	iSRE Institute	
PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)	PMI	

SKILLS

Container Platform: Kubernetes, AKS, EKS, GKE, Docker, Helm, KEDA (autoscaling), RBAC, Network Policies, Pod Security

GitOps & CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab CI, ArgoCD (GitOps principles), Helm multi-env workflows

IaC: Terraform, Ansible, AWS CDK, ARM templates, Azure Policy / OPA (governance)

Cloud: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Key Vault, Monitor, Log Analytics, App Insights, VNet, IAM), AWS, GCP

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, Dynatrace, Splunk, Azure Monitor, CloudWatch, MS App Insights

Security: SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, Trivy (adjacent), SAST/DAST/IAST, Azure Key Vault, secrets management, SOX/GDPR

Languages: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Go

SRE: SLI/SLO, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Blameless Postmortems, ITIL, ServiceNow